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Section 2

Creating Identities: Constructing Pasts,
Disseminating Heritage

5 Contemporary Fabrication of Pasts and the Creation of New Identities?

Open-Air Museums and Historical Theme Parks in the UK and China

Carol Ludwig and Yi-Wen Wang

Abstract

This chapter examines the selective usage of history, relics and practice to reconstruct specific versions of the past. The open-air Beamish Museum in Durham, UK and the historical theme parks in Hangzhou and Kaifeng, China are used as comparative case studies to unpack first, how 'heritage' is conceptualised in each context, and second, how particular versions of the past are selected, (re)invented, disseminated and consumed for contemporary purposes. Set within a theoretical framework of 'living heritage' and an analytical framework of the overlapping themes of authenticity, identity and national pride, tourism and education, the chapter examines the different ways in which the appropriation of cultural heritage takes place at each site. In doing so, we draw attention to the disparate interpretations of conservation practice and the idea of 'living heritage' in the UK and China and debate their continued relevance in the contemporary heritage discourse.

Keywords: living heritage, perceived authenticity, open-air museums, historical theme parks

Introduction

The purpose of this chapter is to examine the selective usage of history, relics and practice to reconstruct specific versions of the past. The open-air Beamish Museum in Durham, UK and the Song Dynasty theme parks in

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Hangzhou and Kaifeng, China are used as comparative case studies to unpack first, how 'heritage' is conceptualised in each context; and second, how particular versions of the past are selected, (re)invented, disseminated and consumed for contemporary purposes. Using the over-lapping themes of authenticity, the (re)construction of identities, tourism and education as an analytical framework, the different ways in which the appropriation of cultural heritage takes place at each site is critically examined. In doing so, we draw attention to the disparate interpretations of conservation practice and the idea of 'living heritage' in the UK and China and debate their continued relevance in the contemporary heritage discourse. The theoretical context within which these interpretations are positioned is briefly introduced below.

Theoretical Framework

From the birth of the conservation ethic during the nineteenth century in Europe (Delafons 1997) 'Western' interpretations of heritage and approaches to its identification, selection and subsequent management have experienced relative long-term stability (Hudson & James, 2007). Yet over the last two decades the wider heritage discourse has steadily evolved and experienced nuances (Ludwig 2016) aligning with wider international trends in heritage thought (see UNESCO 2003; Bonnici 2009; Meyer-Bisch 2009; CoE 2011 and Sykes & Ludwig 2015). These modifications to the heritage discourse largely relate to notions of inclusiveness, widening not only the definition of heritage itself to include those more intangible aspects, but also widening public participation in its management. Parallel to this shift, many countries have simultaneously witnessed a visible growth in the levels of general public interest in heritage and *social* history (evidenced in the UK by increases in National Trust annual visitor numbers (National Trust 2012), and the popularity of television programmes such as 'The Secret History of Our Streets' and 'Who do you think you are?', for example. Within this evolving context, there are three key approaches to heritage management that warrant particular attention. These include: the material-based approach (which reflects the long-standing principles of Western-based conservation), the values-based approach (which expands on these traditional principles), and the living heritage approach (which challenges the well-established principles of the former two approaches [Poulios 2014]), discussed in more detail below.

Material-based Approach

Originating in Western Europe, the material-based approach to heritage management is often described as the 'conventional approach' (Poulios 2014: 17) and is characterised by Smith (2006) as the 'Authorised Heritage Discourse' or AHD. The AHD has been criticised for revolving around 'materiality and the fabric of the past' and focuses exclusively 'upon processes of designating, listing and registering various "parts" of the historic environment selected by experts as worthy of protection' (Waterton & Smith 2008: 199; DCMS 2003: 10-11). In privileging the physical fabric of the built heritage, this approach has also been criticised for discrediting and silencing alternative conceptualisations of heritage that sit firmly outside this mainstream, tangible-focused interpretation. Consequently, the material-based approach has faced some degree of criticism, particularly from ethnic and minority groups, who seek to 'make visible plural and more subjective contemporary representations of heritage' (Ludwig 2016: 811). As a result of such criticism, the conventional conservation orthodoxy has been challenged to acknowledge the notion that heritage becomes heritage because it is valued as such; immutable intrinsic value is not merely found within the physical fabric of a building.

Values-based Approach

Unlike the material-based approach, the values-based approach focuses on 'the values that society, consisting of various stakeholder groups, ascribes to heritage' (Poulios 2014: 18). Stemming from the Burra Charter (ICOMOS 1999) and adapting to further developments such as the adoption of the Convention for the Safeguarding of Intangible Cultural Heritage (UNESCO 2003) and the Framework Convention on the Value of Cultural Heritage for Society ('Faro convention' 2005), the values-based approach has developed and been advocated internationally (Poulios 2014). While the values-based approach clearly provides the opportunity for a more inclusive understanding of heritage to be applied during decision-making, such an approach is more frequently observed in nations where indigenous and minority communities have vocalised their discontent at the established material-based approach often adopted by state authorities representing majority populations (Smith & Waterton 2009). Despite the powerful rhetoric of the values-based approach, the reality of its implementation, particularly in Western Europe, has been negligible (Sykes and Ludwig 2015; Ludwig 2016). Indeed, when the values-based approach is acknowledged in the UK,

attempts are made to merely *shoe-horn* its principles into the deep-rooted, conventional material-based approach operating in conservation practice. In attempting to combine the two approaches, the initial openness and inclusivity sought by understanding heritage values is swiftly diluted due to the restrictions and constraints of the material-based approach (such as the need for tangible evidence, authenticity and scientific fact to validate heritage claims). Such limitations, however, appear less relevant in the living heritage approach; an approach primarily observed outside the legal frameworks of conservation management.

Living Heritage Approach

Living heritage is an approach that is more concerned with ‘continuity’ and in particular the continuity of a community’s connection with heritage ‘... expressed through (traditional) knowledge, management systems, and maintenance practices; and the continuous process of evolving tangible and intangible heritage expressions in response to changing circumstances’ (Poulios 2014: 21). In this regard, a living heritage approach does not necessarily aim to preserve the physical fabric of buildings but instead sees the value of the heritage to be the (intangible) connection between the community and their heritage (Wijesuriya 2005; Poulios 2014). Indeed, living heritage places the emphasis on people. It advocates that ‘no matter how different pasts are produced, accessed or consumed, connecting with them is always an activity that is rooted in the present’ (Ludwig 2016: 812). As such, living heritage focuses not just on the past (or future generations) but crucially, on the present. According to UNESCO, ‘intangible cultural heritage’ can also be referred to as ‘living heritage’ or ‘living culture’ (UNESCO 2017), and intangible cultural heritage, they argue, ‘refers to the practices, representations, expressions, knowledge and skills handed down from generation to generation’. Like Massey (1995), they advocate that this form of heritage plays a particularly fundamental role in legitimising and mobilising current identities, providing communities with a sense of belonging that is continuously recreated in response to their environment (UNESCO 2017). Poulios (2014: 30) however, underlines a key difference between the two terms highlighting that unlike ‘intangible heritage’, ‘living heritage’ crucially ‘embraces both tangible *and* intangible heritage’ [emphasis added]. The concept is not particularly new in the UK, referring mainly to special events and attractions outside the formal/legal heritage management process. Indeed, several events are regularly advertised as such, for example craft fairs and country shows (see Living Heritage Events (2017) for instance), which often

include an exhibition of reproduction/replica or restored heritage objects showcased by costumed demonstrators. The appropriation of heritage for entertainment value, however, has received much scholarly criticism, mostly stemming from the heritage industry critique of the 1980s, discussed below.

Disneyfication and the Heritage Industry Critique

A central aspect of the material-based approach to heritage is its concern for authenticity, objective fact and truth. The move towards the *consumption* of heritage in 1980s Britain was therefore heavily criticised for losing the real, authentic sense of heritage and thus damaging its integrity. Historians Patrick Wright (1985) and Robert Hewison (1987) led the critique against heritage in England through their respective publications, 'On Living in an Old Country' (1985) and 'The Heritage Industry: Britain in a Climate of Decline' (1987). The critique was primarily aimed at the economic commodification and 'Disneyfication' of mass heritage tourism (Handler & Saxton 1988; Waitt 2000; Choay 2001), which led to what was considered a 'false' depiction of the past. Hewison (1987: 139) defined the heritage industry as:

... a set of imprisoning walls upon which we project a superficial image of a false past, simultaneously turning our backs on the reality of history, and incapable of moving forward because of the absorbing fantasy before us.

The idea that heritage was being manufactured as a bogus commodity became a concern echoed by other scholars, leading to the rise of phrases such as the Disneyfication or McDonaldisation of heritage for tourists (Smith 2006; Lowenthal 1985) and derogatory exclamations that, '[...] Britain has been turned into one big theme park' (Lammy 2006: 67). Such criticisms insisted that the commercialisation of reproduction heritage was inauthentic, lacked integrity and sanitised and/or simplified the historical messages of the past. The concept of authenticity, applied globally, is however context-specific and subject to diverse interpretations. The Nara Document on Authenticity of 1994 (1995) for instance, defines authenticity as 'original and subsequent characteristics of the cultural heritage' (Article 9, xxii), and even the 1964 Venice Charter expects the test of authenticity to be applied by individual countries, within the framework of their respective culture and traditions (ICOMOS 1965). This provides space for negotiation and adaptation. After joining the Convention Concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage in 1985, China recognised and applied the concept of authenticity (*yuanzhenxing* 原真性, literally 'original/real, trustworthy/

nature') to heritage conservation practice (Zhu 2013). A critical question for the Chinese case in the interpretation of authenticity related to 'whether or not the *original* state is essential' (Zhu 2013: 189, emphasis added). Liang Sicheng (1901-1972), a pioneering figure in the preservation and conservation of Chinese architecture put forward the notion of 'restoring the old as it was' (Zhu 2013: 189), however transparency about contemporary additions and restored heritage (new 'old' things) was considered good practice (ICOMOS 1965) and a marrying of these ideas can be observed across China. More recently, notions of 'experiential' (or 'existential') authenticity have further complicated understandings of the term (Wang 1999). Such interpretations of authenticity suggest that one's *experience* of the heritage should be original, real and trustworthy (see Zhu 2013), rather than the originality of the tangible objects themselves or the environment within which such objects are placed. Such diverse and contrasting understandings of a core concept, therefore, raise questions as to the role that open-air museums in the UK and historical theme parks in China (created for people to experience heritage and to serve both educational and entertainment purposes) have played in sustaining the connection between people and their heritage and thus ensuring continuity with the past. The following sections examine and compare an open-air museum founded in England during the 1970s and two historical theme parks opened during the 1990s in China. In doing so, this chapter seeks to understand how the past is selected, (re)invented, disseminated by the creators and/or suppliers of the tourism industries or dictated by consumers' demands (which can also be created); and how heritage is conceptualised in these Disneyfied, often fabricated, fairylands.

Case Study 1: Beamish Museum in Durham, UK

Great Britain, and the Northeast of England in particular, pioneered agricultural developments, especially in livestock breeding as early as the 1820s, but the region is better known internationally for its role in the Industrial Revolution. Indeed, the Northeast of England, now underperforming compared with the UK overall and consequently suffering from comparatively high unemployment rates and low average income brackets (Tighe 2016), once led the world in the industrial production of coal, lead, iron, chemicals, glass pottery and textiles (Beamish Museum 2014). Toward the end of the nineteenth century, Teesside, a conurbation in the Northeast of England around the urban centre of Middlesbrough, was producing one third of the nation's iron output and the shipyards of the Tyne and Wear were producing two thirds of the

nation's shipping tonnage (Darsley & Jarman 2011). By 1913 production from the Great Northern Coalfield was at its peak and by 1914 a substantial proportion of British and world trade originated in the Northeast (Darsley & Jarman 2011). So why was the Northeast the birthplace of the Industrial Revolution?

Coal production in the eighteenth century was initially concentrated in the Northeast as a result of favourable geomorphological and geographic conditions. The area not only included coal reserves but also benefitted from relatively shallow pits located along the banks of the rivers Tyne and Wear which made it easy to haul and transport the coal via river to the sea (Beamish Museum 2014). Such natural and locational advantages were further built upon by the man-made development of steam-pumping and the safety lamp, which enabled pits to be sunken to much greater depths and dug farther inland (Beamish Museum 2014). The result of this expansion led to the development of waggonways or 'coal roads' (later to be replaced by railways) and pit communities, housing workers and their families. The Stockton and Darlington Railway became the world's first public steam-hauled passenger railway (opened in 1825) and led to the widespread adoption of railways for the transportation of people and goods, including coal, throughout the country and the world (Beamish 2014). The late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries were thus an era of significant wealth and prosperity in the UK and the Northeast, though destined not to last.

Starting in the 1920s, the region underwent a period of long industrial decline due to the 'relative decline in shipbuilding, the exhaustion of the older parts of the Northeast coalfield and a relative loss of dynamism in some of the engineering sectors' (European Commission 2008: 9). The 1960s in particular saw the closure of 'many small unproductive pits across the region' (European Commission 2008: 10) and this downward spiral was then further exacerbated by the 1980s recession. During this time industry closed 'due to a lack of competitiveness', as well as increased 'internationalisation of markets and low levels of investment in innovation' (European Commission 2008: 11). Privatisation of utilities (energy and water) and lack of investment in the railways were added factors leading to the death of the region's heavy industry, and the mass unemployment and poverty that followed. According to Trimm (2012: 528) 'heritage operated as a compensation for the decline of the British industrial base in the postwar era' and Beamish Museum is a prime example.

The Founding of Beamish Museum

Inspired by museums he visited on his travels around Norway and Sweden, Frank Atkinson was the Beamish Museum's founder and first director.

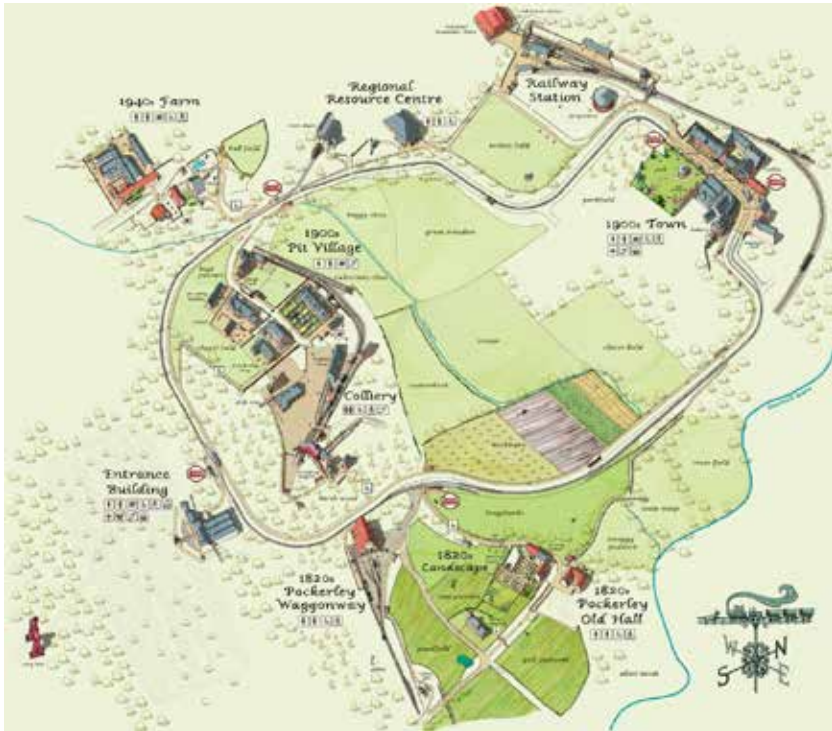
Atkinson was concerned not only about the disappearance of the Northeast's industries, but also about the Northeast region losing its identity, customs and traditions (Beamish Museum 2014). As a result, he set out to convince the local municipality, Durham County Council, that there was an urgent need to gather and save materials and machinery associated with the dying industries. Such material objects, he suggested, could then be displayed in a new open-air museum, a technique founded by Artur Hazeluis in Sweden (Darsley & Jarman 2011). According to Hewison (1987: 88-89), memorialising early industry in this way was born out of a distinct fear of loss associated not only with the de-industrialisation of the Northeast, but also with the loss of the communities that served such industries.

Atkinson's approach started with a policy of 'unselective collecting' of items that included donations of industrial equipment from shipping, rail and manufacturing industries (Trimm 2012), as well as large donations of everyday items from the general public. This approach was deemed inclusive, enabling a bond to develop between local communities and the museum, actively empowering the former. Following this, Atkinson's next step was to organise the complete removal of several buildings from their original locations in the Northeast and the comprehensive rebuilding of these at Beamish. After several stages of negotiation, leading to an eventual joint agreement signed by eight local authorities in the Northeast, Beamish finally opened its doors to the public in February 1970 (Darsley & Jarman 2011). Beamish was marketed as 'The Living Museum of the North' (Beamish Museum 2014) and was framed as ethnographic and authentic (Trimm 2012) and 'something to be proud of' (Atkinson 1999: 87). As an open-air, living museum, dissemination and consumption of the material and social heritage was very different from conventional exhibitions in traditional museums or visits to open-access castles, monuments and stately homes. Instead, Beamish was designed to bring the history of the Northeast to life through entertainment, interaction and experience.

What and How Is Heritage Presented?

Beamish can be described as operating 'through an ethnographic presentation of a modernizing and industrializing people' (Trimm 2012: 529), where 'people from the past welcome visitors and interpret how the people of the North of England lived and worked' (Dayoutwiththekids 2017). Set over a large, 350-acre site, visitors to Beamish can navigate the site on foot, or can experience the 1920s restored trams and restored and replica buses, driven by costumed chauffeurs to travel around the site. Based on two main time

Figure 5.1 Map of Beamish Museum



Source: Beamish Museum www.beamish.org.uk

zones, the early 1800s and early 1900s, Beamish presents the 1820s Pockerley Waggonway and the 1820s Pockerley Old Hall, a 1900s pit village, colliery and town (including a public house, various shops, services such as a dentist, solicitor, music teacher, bank, and a school) and a 1940s farm (Figure 5.1 map).

Based around the concept of living heritage, Beamish is clearly not just about the tangible, built heritage, although this is an important backdrop. Instead, the emphasis at Beamish is on people; their way of life, work, recreation and education (Darsley & Jarman 2011). In this respect, Beamish employs many costumed demonstrators who can be found in every building performing the role of shop keeper, bank clerk, tram and bus driver, chemist, teacher, etc. (Figure 5.2). These demonstrators (actors) interact with visitors through serving them, demonstrating aspects of their job, or simply talking to them about their life. In doing so, they seek to give visitors an authentic experience of what life was like during this period.

Advertised as a family day out, Beamish is marketed as an authentic, open-air museum that provides entertainment and education for visitors

Figure 5.2 A costumed demonstrator as a bank clerk



Source: Carol Ludwig

of all ages and interests (Beamish Museum 2014), and as a living museum (i.e., no glass cabinets, labels or interpretive signs), Beamish relies heavily on its costumed demonstrators to disseminate the Beamish story.

Indeed, Beamish's demonstrators appear very knowledgeable about their particular role(s) and explicitly portray a sense of both enthusiastic nostalgia and pride in *performing* what their lives are like. While our visits to each building and demonstrator enabled us to conclude that a reasonably factual presentation of life during this time was disseminated, it was also

noticeable that the performance(s) delivered by the demonstrators portrayed positivity and sentimentality, with little or no reference to negative aspects of the time. The primitive dentistry of the time and the fact that female children were not obliged or expected to attend school on 'washing day' was explained with humour. Negative aspects of the period such as the poor environmental and sanitary conditions (pollution, inequality) did not appear to be included in the exhibition as the clear message to be disseminated was about the hard working, pioneering working communities of a modernising and industrialising people at the forefront of history. While museum exhibitions and heritage displays by their nature always involve selectivity, it is important to assess to what extent Beamish's claim to be authentic, is valid.

Authenticity

The concept of 'authenticity' is a very 'Westernised' idea of heritage and is central to the conservation repair orthodoxy of cultural heritage objects across Europe (Pendlebury 2009: 173). In China and Japan, for instance, historic buildings may be frequently demolished and rebuilt with contemporary materials, and may even be moved without diminishing the alleged authenticity of the building or site (Graham 2002), whereas by contrast, restoration in England is repeatedly criticised for delivering 'reproduction heritage', deemed to be 'meticulously researched and beautifully executed fakery, but fakery nonetheless' (SPAB cited in Larkham 1996: 263). In the UK, 'authenticity' tends therefore to be presented as an essential key orienteering point for assessing the validity of heritage claims and, as Hobson (2004: 53) explains, it is deemed to be 'objectively definable and recognisable, given appropriate professional training'. As aforesaid, Beamish as it exists today has developed slowly over the last four decades. It benefits from some *in situ* heritage assets, such as the Mahogany drift mine (Figure 5.3), which is a major heritage attraction (opened in 1855) and visitors can take part in a guided tour of the mine, enabling them to experience the dark, damp and cramped conditions for themselves.

Beamish however has also benefitted from continuous collecting, moving, and restoring of its collection (Darsley & Jarman 2011), and several recent replica new-builds, discussed in detail below. In this context Beamish has experienced some degree of scholarly criticism and scepticism because of its 'reconstructed nature' (Hewison 1987) and is criticised for being 'fabricated from performers or demonstrators "performing the past" and facilities arranged in facsimile' (Trimm 2012: 529; Hewison 1987).

Figure 5.3 Coal works of the Mahogany drift mine



Source: Carol Ludwig

Relocated Heritage

While donations to the museum including artefacts, furnishings, decor and clothing are said to be original and thus authentic, several key built heritage attractions have either been moved to the site and rebuilt and restored or are new replica 'old buildings'. For example, six of the original row of 27 Francis Street miners' cottages (Figure 5.4), originally built in the early 1860s by Hetton Coal Company, were relocated from their original site in Hetton-le-Hole, on Wearside to Beamish and were rebuilt in the pit village in 1976 (Beamish Museum 2014: 18).

Likewise, the school building (Figure 5.5) originally opened in 1892 in East Stanley was relocated to the Museum in 1992 and the 1850s Pit Hill Chapel, originally located near to the Museum's entrance was also rebuilt in the pit village.

In the 1900s town, the Co-op, along with the bakery, originally from Annfield Plain in County Durham, were moved to Beamish in the late 1970s/early 1980s and the latter 'was transformed into an Edwardian bakery' (Beamish Museum 2014: 46). Moreover, six of the 25-home Ravensworth Terrace, originally located in Bensham Bank, Gateshead (Figure 5.6) and built in the 1830s for professionals and tradesmen, were relocated to Beamish in the 1970s and rebuilt between 1980-1985 (Beamish Museum 2014).

The Sun Inn public house is another example of relocation, being moved from Bondgate in Bishop Auckland in 1985, and Eston Church, originally

Figure 5.4 The miners' cottages relocated from Wearside



Source: Carol Ludwig

Figure 5.5 The school building relocated from East Stanley



Source: Carol Ludwig

from Eston, near Middlesbrough is described as ‘the oldest and most complex building ever moved by Beamish’ (Beamish Museum 2014: 94). Dismantled in 1998, it was subsequently rebuilt at the Museum in 2011/12. While the aforementioned structures were rebuilt using largely the original fabric, other attractions at Beamish only use parts of the original historic fabric and are thus referred to as ‘authentic recreations’, as explained below.

Figure 5.6 Ravensworth Terrace from Bensham Bank, Gateshead



Source: Carol Ludwig

Authentic Recreations

The masonic hall (Figure 5.7), for instance, is marketed as an ‘authentic recreation’ providing ‘a unique insight into the world of the Freemasons in the early 20th century’ (Beamish Museum 2014: 72). While the frontage has been relocated in 2006 from a former Masonic hall in Park Terrace, Sunderland (originally built in 1869) the demonstrator inside the hall explained that, like several other buildings in the Museum, the masonic hall could not be rebuilt using all of the exact same materials for cost reasons so were instead built to be outstanding representations of the originals. The masonic hall, for instance used wood instead of marble and an original archway detail was removed and simplified for cost reasons.

Replica Buildings

The final category of buildings found at Beamish are replicas or representations of original buildings. The Beamish Motor and Cycle Works (Figure 5.8), for example, opened at Beamish in 1994 and is described in the Beamish Guide book (available for purchase in the souvenir shop) as ‘a replica of a typical town garage’ (Beamish Museum 2014: 48). Likewise, the Printer, Stationer and Newspaper branch office (Figure 5.9), which opened in the mid-1980s and the Jubilee Confectioners (sweet shop), which opened in 1994 are replicas, designed to represent typical examples. The Confectioners

Figure 5.7 The Masonic Hall in the background



Source: Carol Ludwig

Figure 5.8 The Beamish Motor and Cycle Works

Source: Carol Ludwig

Figure 5.9 The newspaper branch office



Source: Carol Ludwig

Figure 5.10 The chemist and plate photographer

Source: Carol Ludwig

includes a factory where visitors can watch traditional sweets, chocolate and toffee being made ‘using techniques and equipment from the era’ (Beamish Museum 2014: 68) and these can then be purchased in the shop. The chemist and plate photographer (Figure 5.10) is a new addition to the 1900s Town and is designed to replicate a typical chemist, including dispensary, and photographer’s studio. Its design is said to be ‘based on a real building in Durham City’ (Beamish Museum 2014: 74). These key museum attractions are extremely popular with visitors to Beamish, yet they would all fail to meet the deep-rooted, scientific tangible heritage criteria of the Western conservation orthodoxy or AHD, regardless of how similar they may look to the original buildings. Despite this, the museum and its employees proudly stress the authenticity and accuracy of their performances and displays.

Identity and National Pride

Pride in the perceived authenticity (MacCannell 1973; Ramkissoon & Uysal 2011) of the Museum, is equally matched by pride in the depiction of the past performed by the costumed demonstrators. Indeed, the exhibits (made up of buildings, furnishings, artefacts, etc.) together with all of

the employed 'performers' portray an explicit sense of pride, emphasising that the forward-thinking UK, and the Northeast in particular, is the birthplace of many developments in engineering, agriculture and transport (Darsley & Jarman 2011). This positive message reworks and reinforces 'ideas of Britishness' (Trimm 2012: 534) and (re)constructs a shared identity situated around 'nationality and modernity' (Trimm 2012: 529). In doing so, the depiction of the past portrays a nationalisation of British history which is all-inclusive and positive. This sense of greatness, wealth, full employment, and prosperity arguably serves to create a sense of implicit discomfort with the present. Indeed, the demonstrators discuss the achievements of the time, painting a picture of a region that was tough, tenacious, and full of inventiveness and ingenuity (Darsley & Jarman 2011). In doing so, they produce a distinctive gulf/distance between *then* and *now*, and a 'nostalgic longing' (Trimm 2012: 533) is conveyed and encouraged. Moreover, the historical narrative conveyed to visitors is clearly sanitised and simplified. The past is reconstructed using predominantly 'comforting aspects of class and modernity' (Trimm 2012: 530) and the implicit dangers associated with the pit work are included in this narrative only to emphasise the toughness and strength of the Northeast people and the working class.

This sanitised version of the past is clearly designed to ignite a strong sense of pride and national/regional identity, which can individualise the UK and the Northeast (thereby benefiting the tourism industry, discussed below), and just as importantly be passed on to new generations as part of Beamish's educative role.

Education and Tourism

Beamish receives more than 500,000 visitors each year and is the holder of several awards including British Museum of the Year award, Gold Award (2012), Large Visitor Attraction of the Year, Visit England Award for Excellence (Beamish Museum 2014), and in 1987 the European Museum of the Year award (European Museum Forum 2017). Over the last four decades Beamish has continued to expand, with new projects and developments planned for the future, including offering overnight accommodation in an 1820s style coaching inn, and the construction of early industry such as candle-makers, potters and blacksmiths (Beamish Museum 2014). The continued growth of Beamish emphasises its success as a heritage attraction and illustrates the contribution Beamish makes to the UK and regional tourism industry.

Beamish receives international, national and regional tourists, and offers special events and discounts for groups of school children as part of its educative role.

Indeed, marketing material for Beamish emphasises the importance of conveying the history of the Northeast to younger generations in particular. For this purpose, a Regional Resource Centre was set up at the Museum in 2001 and 'many thousands of school children and students come [...] each year' (Beamish Museum 2014: 121). The guide book also emphasises that students 'can explore many contemporary issues through sessions in our historic settings' (Beamish Museum 2014: 121), attempting to develop the continuity link that is so important in living heritage projects between the past, the present and the future.

Summary

The sections above have discussed the particular versions of the past selected and (re)invented at Beamish, as well as the dissemination techniques adopted. They also point to the contemporary purpose(s) of heritage consumption for the UK and the Northeast region in particular.

While Beamish attempts to present the past in an authentic way, as a fabricated construct which has grown through the continuous rebuilding, relocating, restoring and replicating of original buildings, the museum has been subject to some degree of scholarly criticism. While the heritage 'performances' and the exhibits within the museum are largely factual, they have a tendency to omit more negative accounts of the period, carefully disseminating a consistent sanitised narrative based on national/regional pride and identity. While the authenticity and factual nature of Beamish is an important part of the museum's marketing, equally important is the entertainment value Beamish can offer to the whole family. For instance, the museum is heralded as providing not only the opportunity to learn about the region's past, but also a 'family day out'. Beamish's consistently growing tourist numbers confirm the popularity of the museum, regardless of its perceived authenticity or official heritage 'status', and upon leaving the museum, visitors will have gathered a sense of what life was like for working communities involved in these industries and leave with a sense of nostalgic pride. The following sections recount a similar series of events in China, but present a marked difference in the ways in which heritage is conceptualised, commodified and consumed.

Case Study 2: Song Dynasty Theme Parks in Hangzhou and Kaifeng, China

Since the economic reforms began in 1978, the Chinese government has moved away from a socialist ideology and repositioned itself as an entrepreneurial state, promoting economic growth, urban expansion, and globalisation. In response to the state's shift toward entrepreneurialism, local authorities have consequently adjusted their approaches to governance and formulated strategies and policies to prompt development for the purpose of achieving competitiveness domestically and internationally. The trajectory of development and growth in each city has invariably been charted by political leadership and economic enterprise as much as drawn from local resources and cultural heritage. The creation of imaginary Song Dynasty Towns in Hangzhou (1996) and Kaifeng (1998) is a telling example that illustrates how the distant past of China is selected, fabricated, performed and commodified by the local authorities in Hangzhou and Kaifeng to make their city financially more competitive by reclaiming their distinctive identities as imperial capitals of the Song Dynasty (Xu 2008; Wei 2012).

The Inspiration behind Song Dynasty Towns in Hangzhou and Kaifeng

The creation of the two aforementioned theme parks are said to have been inspired by the same historical panoramic scroll 'Along the River during the Qingming Festival', attributed to an otherwise unknown painter Zhang Zeduan (fl. early twelfth century) (Guo 2004; Du 2015; Lin 2015; Li 2016; Ong & Jin 2017). Once thought to depict the ceremonial rituals of the Qingming Festival, the painting has more frequently been understood to portray a panorama of city life in early spring in the capital Bianjing (today's Kaifeng) of the Northern Song Dynasty (960-1126) (Tsao 2003). Despite uncertainty about both the artist and the painting, the theme park in Kaifeng is a materialisation of the painting on what was believed to be its 'original' location and the inspiration for the artist. The Kaifeng theme park was named after the painting in Chinese ('Qingming shanghe yuan'), but named 'Millennium City Park' in English, emphasising its former role as an imperial capital at the turn of the first millennium. The completion of the Kaifeng theme park in 1998, however, fell two years behind the other theme park in Hangzhou, known as 'Songcheng' ('Song City').

Narratives of the creation of Songcheng in Hangzhou have been constructed based on the fact that the city was the capital of the Southern Song

Figure 5.11 Territory of Northern and Southern Song and location of their capital cities Kaifeng and Lin'an



Source: Adapted from Mozzan 2015; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Song_dynasty

Dynasty (1127-1279), although it was not the capital said to be depicted in the historical scroll (Figure 5.11). Both the Hangzhou and Kaifeng theme parks make explicit reference to the historical panoramic scroll on their official websites, and numerous reporters as well as academics have repeatedly associated the two parks with the painting.

The creation of these two parks has drawn much of its inspiration from one of the most iconic Chinese paintings and used it as a blueprint for creating an idealised historical townscape at the end of the 20th century. But whether the urban scenes depicted in the original twelfth-century work were actually of Kaifeng or were instead an idealised portrait of an imaginary city is still debated (Tsao 2003). Whether it was Kaifeng or not, the painting was revered by later scholars and artists, who created a number of replica versions in subsequent dynasties. Later versions, naturally, elaborated on and exaggerated aspects of the earlier versions as well as the original (Figure 5.12).

What and How Is Heritage Presented?

Similar to Beamish, both tangible and intangible aspects of heritage were considered essential to create or, more specifically, invent a make-believe city scene that existed a thousand years ago. The Millennium City Park in Kaifeng has put in a great deal of effort into recreating the architectural landmarks and cityscape depicted in the painting (Ong & Jin 2017). Songcheng in Hangzhou, on the other hand, has prized itself for its theatrical performances,

Figure 5.12 Part of the twelfth-century Song original and an eighteenth-century copy (depicting the City Gate)



Source: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Alongtheriver_QingMing.jpg and https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Along_the_River_7-119-3.jpg

which were for the very first time in China staged in a cultural theme park (Du 2015). Both, however, go to extraordinary lengths to simulate scenes of everyday life at that time.

Fabricated Architectural Heritage

Architecture provides an important foundation for the two theme parks to make the experience of travelling back in time more intuitively or perceptually plausible. Whereas the two parks each cover an area of 100 acres, they adopted somewhat different approaches toward architectural ‘authenticity’. It is proudly claimed that the buildings in the Kaifeng theme park were built according to a technical treatise on architectural craftsmanship standards, titled *Yingzao Fashi* (State Building Standards) published and enforced by the Song Emperor Huizong (Guo 1998). Buildings and structures in Kaifeng are therefore seen as a material realisation of prosperous and peaceful scenes of Bianjing as imagined or interpreted by *not* the original painter *but* his following imitators. Several temples, palaces and pavilions in the Millennium Park are multi-storey replicas of those depicted in the copies, especially the most refined version created in the eighteenth century but not in the twelfth-century original. The Rainbow Bridge (Hong Qiao), one of the architectural landmarks in the painting, for instance, was made of timber in the original, then replaced by a stone bridge in the 18th-century Qing Dynasty remake (Figure 5.13) and finally realised in the Millennium

Figure 5.13 The Rainbow Bridge in the twelfth- and eighteenth-century paintings



Source: Same as Figure 5.12

Park in steel (Figure 5.14). Some imposing edifices have never appeared in any later copies of the scroll and are newly invented in the Park – as if the theme park itself is another version of the painting in the 21st-century (Ong & Jin 2017). Different from the previous copies, this version is a reinterpretation of the painting for visitors to experience, rather than for emperors to appreciate or collect.

Songcheng in Hangzhou, on the other hand, mainly consists of one or two-storey shops or courtyard houses, with the exception of the City Gate as the only tall building in the park, bearing more resemblance to the twelfth-century painting. However, for a theme park, authenticity tends to be achieved with a minimum of fuss. Rainbow Bridge here becomes a roof-covered bridge with timber truss underneath, ornamentally supporting the reinforced-concrete bridge structure (Figure 5.15). Several places in the park, such as grottos, the ghost house, mazes, etc., are purposely created to fulfil visitor expectations for entertainment, compromising the ‘integrity’ of the historical theme park.

Figure 5.14 The Rainbow Bridge in Millennium City Park, Kaifeng



Source: Lüsezhuzhu

Figure 5.15 The Rainbow Bridge in Songcheng, Hangzhou



Source: Yiwen Wang

Dissemination of Intangible Heritage

Both of the two parks feature a wide range of activities that are generally associated with traditional arts, craftsmanship or specialties – sometimes without regard to whether they existed during the Song period or not. Costumed demonstrators perform traditional handicrafts, such as the making of hand fans, swords, embroidered textiles, clay sculpture, knots and wood carving. Other traditional skilled occupations, including making tofu, rice cakes, and sugar painting along with various sweets and snack shops also play an important part in simulating and diversifying commercial activities of the time and enrich the tourist visiting experience. The advertisement of Hangzhou's Songcheng (Songcheng Group 2017) vividly encapsulates the aura of the Song Dynasty that it strives to create:

most food, snacks and drinks provided in the park can be dated back to that era. Visitors will find themselves wandering in an ancient city, surrounded by people from all walks of life in Song Dynasty. They can try their luck in an ancient Chinese style casino, appease their own curiosity by touring in a Song prostitute's boudoir, or buy a rice cake or tofu made on site with tools featuring hundreds years of history.

Although endeavours to evoke associations with the period are noticeably made in both cases, casual references to an unspecified historical period are fairly commonplace. In particular, folklore performances derive inspiration from a wide range of social and religious customs (including marriage, the civil service examinations, dragon and lion dances, riverside markets, etc.); acrobatics and entertainment shows (such as shadow plays, puppet shows, stilt walking, martial arts, cock fights, monkey tricks, face-changing, etc.); or ancient and local legendary characters of the Song (such as the fictionalisation of the patriotic General Yue Fei and the government official Bao Zheng, known as 'Judge Bao' for his unparalleled uprightness and integrity).

These endeavours to recreate a historical scene – be it historically proven or completely fictional – have been recognised by the local government and both parks have been proclaimed by the local heritage authority as a 'Demonstration Site for Chinese Intangible Heritage' (Lin 2015). Indeed, several local craftsman and skilled artisans have been recruited or invited to work in the theme parks on a daily or regular basis to demonstrate or transmit traditional handicraft.

Theatrical Interpretations of the Song Dynasty

Theatrical performance is another manifestation of how heritage is presented in the theme park. Theatrical performances or live entertainment shows have usually appeared in themed hotels or casinos, and its appearance in a historical theme park in Hangzhou was the first in China. The commercial success of Songcheng and the like have led to the support of the Ministry of Culture and the National Tourism Administration to encourage the incorporation of performing arts into the tourism industry by introducing theatrical performances at heritage sites or historical theme parks (Song & Cheung 2010). The last decade therefore has witnessed a growth of theatrical performances in China. These performances vary in types, indoor or outdoor, but are often large in scale, featuring artistic interpretation of historic events, literary works or ethnic folklore.

The advertising slogan of Songcheng emphasises that the park has 'architecture as form; culture as soul' (Songcheng Group 2017) and visitors go there for 'one day in exchange of an experience of a thousand years'. The spectacular theatrical performance, titled 'The Romance of the Song Dynasty' is staged indoor every day at the Grand Theatre (Song & Cheung 2010). Different from traditional performances such as Peking opera, contemporary theatrical performances utilise a wide range of high-tech tools such as laser, lighting, fire, waterfalls and high-definition giant screens, etc. to dazzle spectators with special effects. The local legends, particularly love stories associated with Hangzhou such as the legend of the White Snake and the Butterfly Lovers, are put on the stage and captivate the audience with folk dances and songs, acrobatic feats, sword fights, horse riding and so forth. As noted by Zhan and Kong (2016), the long-lasting popularity of 'The Romance of the Song Dynasty' in Songcheng has derived from its constant 'reinvention' of local legends and anecdotes. Although criticised by Li (2016) for its 'staged authenticity' (MacCannell 1973), most Chinese scholars or critics praise it as a 'must-see in your lifetime' (Zhang 2009; Lin 2015; Wang 2016; Yu & Jiang 2017) or an iconic performance of China 'deserving the title of 'Chinese Broadway' and 'one of the top three theatrical performances of the world' alongside the O show of Cirque du Soleil in Las Vegas and Le Moulin Rouge in Paris (Zhejiang Provincial Tourism Bureau 2015).

In contrast to the indoor performances in Hangzhou, Kaifeng showcases several small-scale outdoor live performances, two large-scale battle reenactments during the daytime and a theatrical performance at night. One of the re-enacted battles is performed on land, depicting a heroic episode in the career of the patriotic general Yue Fei on horseback slaying an enemy. The other battle is performed on water, recreating the epic battle scene on the

Bian River when Song forces resisted the invasion of the Jurchen Jin. After the Song defeat, the capital was moved to Hangzhou. While the two reenactments are designed to evoke emotional responses by creating visual imagery of a selected heroic or tragic episode of the past, the night-time theatrical performance 'The Great Song Dynasty-Reminiscences of the Eastern Capital' is staged on a man-made lake, set to evoke more positive images of the Song Dynasty as a golden era of peace, growth and prosperity, bustling with life and activity. As its advertising slogan goes, the performance is designed to provide visitors with a sensory experience to 'walk into the painting and wander around in the scenes of a thousand years ago' (Songcheng Group 2017).

Rather noticeably, the theatrical interpretations of the Song Dynasty in the two theme parks have not been restricted to the scenes in the painting but cite references to anecdotes and legends that people know well about this particular period from television and radio programmes, and other public media. Intriguingly, only a few critics condemn this 'impressionist' interpretation of the past and the lack of historical accuracy (Li 2016; Zhang 2016), and many instead praise the lavish productions and their contributions to bring Song history back to life.

Authenticity

As elaborated in the case study on Beamish, the pursuit of material authenticity is seen as the primary aim of heritage conservation and has underpinned subsequent conservation practice in the West for many decades. Conversely, seldom have Chinese deemed it essential to validate a heritage claim for tourism industries. This is, in part, because the traditional practice of architectural conservation not only accepted the replacement of building materials and elements, but also welcomed contemporary intervention and alteration of historic structures: to make them larger, taller, stronger or simply better (Qian 2007; Su 2011; Zhu 2015). This also stems from the fact that the Cultural Revolution destroyed many archival records, and post-Mao urban development has demolished many historical buildings and sites, making the pursuit of material authenticity difficult if not unattainable.

Neither Hangzhou nor Kaifeng possess many physical relics of the past, but instead both showcase a complete 'reconstruction' or 'reproduction' of an idealised past depicted in the painting. While both parks proudly claim success in representing the Song Dynasty townscape portrayed on the historical scroll, the authenticity of the twelfth century painting itself remains in question. No archival evidence can indicate the exact date and

location that the painting was created. The question as to what extent the painter had faithfully recorded the architectural elements in the capital city and depicted accurately the everyday life of ordinary subjects and their activities in the settings – i.e., with realism and without interpretation – has been fiercely debated by historians (Ong & Jin 2017). Such academic debate on authenticity, nonetheless, would not dissuade people from visiting the park nor preclude visitors from accepting the pseudo-historical settings in the park. As aforesaid, it is discernible that the two theme parks present quite a few notions and understandings about the Song Dynasty that are popularised by the mass media. Having conducted a field survey on visitor perceptions of the architectural design and activities in Kaifeng, Ong and Jin (2017:230) report that the ‘simulation of the landscape depicted in the “flat” painting into real 3D space was also found to have gone unchallenged by Chinese visitors’ who ‘appeared convinced ... that the painting depicts and simulates a real Bianjing’. The historical scroll ‘has become iconic to the extent that replicating it on its own is a worthy endeavour because whether or not it is a reproduction of an actual historical landscape and the exact time period in which it was painted would and will not be of importance to visitors’ (Ong & Jin 2017:234-235). In these two cases, it can be argued that ‘the subjective, “experience-centred” notions of tourist authenticity’ has completely overpowered ‘the objective, “object-centred” modern notions of heritage authenticity’ (Guttormsen & Fageraas, 2011; González Martínez 2017:56).

Identity and National Pride

The theme parks in Hangzhou and Kaifeng have thrived on nostalgic longings for an idealised representation of the distant past on the one hand, and on the other, on the local leadership who are driven to make the city more competitive by branding the city with culture. In the 1990s, Hangzhou and Kaifeng both launched a series of initiatives to protect, reinstate and even ‘reconstruct’ or ‘reinvent’ tangible and intangible heritage assets of the city. The two theme parks thrived for the same reason of heritage reconstruction. For cities whose tourism resources are not as globally renowned or competitive as ancient capitals like Beijing (the Great Wall, the Forbidden City) and Xian (the Terracotta Army), any potential cultural resources – be it real, imaginary or fictional – can be utilised, developed and commodified for tourism industries. Hangzhou and Kaifeng both see their past as Song capital cities as a wealth of cultural resource to be tapped. Owing to the absence of physical remains, historical records

and shared memories of the capital city, interpretation of the historical scroll in the theme parks has cashed in on the long temporal gap between then and now, creating an idealised landscape for the everyday life of an all-inclusive society from master craftsmen to unskilled prostitutes; or commemorating heroic figures or failures in defending against foreign peoples on the borders of the empire.

Though presented as a mix of the good, the bad and the ugly, the Song Dynasty remains very positively portrayed and perceived in the theme park. The period is well known for technological advances and economic prosperity. It nurtured three of the Four Great Inventions of China, namely gunpowder, printing and the compass, and enjoyed unprecedented economic and population growth as a result of prioritising foreign trade and merchant shipping industries (Temple & Needham 2007; Ropp 2010). The narratives of the past, as depicted in the built environment and landscape, craft activities of costumed demonstrators, historical reenactments or theatrical productions of the two theme parks are, however, heavily based on an idealistic representation of a Han Chinese worldview, while assuming a harmony between Han Chinese and other ethnic minority populations.

Education and Tourism

Admittedly, cultural theme parks can generate a positive impact on contemporary society, as they serve as a transmitter of local customs and traditions and a show window for domestic or international tourists to obtain a quick grasp of local history and experience in person local cultures (MacCannell 1973). In late 1990s China, various theme parks sprang up as an alternative means to satisfy the increasing demand of the new middle class for leisure or to satisfy their curiosity to understand other regions in China or the outside world. Indeed, while Songcheng is considered as a 4A-rated site (Du 2004), the Millennium Park is listed as a 5A-rated tourist attraction – the highest level of recognition awarded to sites of national importance and acknowledging China's history and culture.

The commercial successes of the Songcheng and the Millennium Park have led to the replication of cultural theme parks in other cities. In early years, cultural theme parks burgeoned in historic cities like Hangzhou and Kaifeng where the history of the city can be commodified and sold, or in the regions where ethnic minorities live. In ensuing decades, however, with the further growth of the middle class population and their demand

for leisure pursuits, new parks were built in areas that possessed little historical, ethnic, or regional features and therefore had to “borrow” vernacular architecture and cultural performance from elsewhere. Not only have various versions of regional or ethnic cultures in China been displaced to the doorstep of consumers, but exotic cultural themes from abroad have also been brought into the existing well-established parks in order to diversify activities and boost revisits. For instance, Songcheng Group built other theme parks in Sanya, Lijiang, Jiuzhai and Guilin, all of which use the same brand ‘Songcheng’ and exhibit a mix of architectural features from both the local region and Hangzhou. The ‘Romantic Show’ in Hangzhou was also replicated in these new parks, with the contents adapted from the romances in the locality – historical, mythical or even fictional. Yu and Jiang (2017) praise highly the success of replicating a Songcheng in Sanya on Hainan Island, in the southernmost part of China, which ironically was originally inhabited by the Li ethnic group but invaded and conquered by Han Chinese during the Song Dynasty. It appears that Chinese scholars in the tourism field have considered positively the use of ‘regional cultures’ of China – even though ‘displaced’ and borrowed’ – for branding and providing themes for amusement parks, given that they enable visitors to appreciate and identify themselves with their ‘Greater China’ roots in a broad sense, i.e., from the Han Chinese perspective. When ‘cultures’ are uprooted from their original time and space and traded as commodities, they run the danger of homogenising a culturally diverse society into a singular whole.

Summary

A fictional version of the distant past was materialised in Hangzhou and Kaifeng, where the history of the city as the capital of a great empire was narrated for the contemporary consumption of heritage and culture. Never have there been attempts to present the past in an authentic way. The Songcheng and the Millennium City Park are both a fabricated ‘heritage’ in which built environments are misleadingly constructed, and traditional customs, handicrafts and legends are casually performed through subjective interpretation of a famous painting. While both the material and immaterial existence of heritage within the parks are largely fakery, they have won more praise than criticism from scholars and been well-received by visitors. The perceived authenticity outweighs completely the material one. It is believed that the historical theme parks should take

on an important role to rejuvenate and bring back to life dying cultural heritage – as evidenced by the designation of the two theme parks as a demonstration site for intangible heritage. The long temporal distance between the Song Dynasty and the present leaves no physical remnants, historical records or shared memories of this particular period of the past, thereby providing ample room for disseminating a sanitised narrative based on Han Chinese identity and an imagined homogeneous national community.

Comparison of Case Studies

Having seen the fabricated construct of the past in the open-air museum and the historical theme parks, the question to be asked is whether it matters if the buildings are original, restored, partly restored or replications? For Beamish, designed by Atkinson to follow a living heritage approach, the intention of the museum is to disseminate an authentic experience to its visitors whereby they learn through being (seeing *and* doing) what life was like during the respective time periods. The creation of the historical theme park in Hangzhou and Kaifeng shares similar goals, but they further capitalise on the city's past as an imperial capital and refashion local identity and cultures for city branding in order to explicitly increase economic competitiveness. Inspired by a historical scroll repeatedly reinvented and reinterpreted throughout history, the two theme parks feature some degree of creativity in reconstructing or reproducing the Song landscape projected by the painting. As Wijesuriya (2005: 37) reiterates, the purpose of a living heritage approach is to maintain continuity, 'even if in certain occasions the fabric might be harmed' or indeed replicated.

Living heritage projects emphasise the intangible connection between 'heritage' and community, rather than the tangible fabric itself (Wijesuriya 2005; Poullos 2014: 23). While this clearly tests existing Western notions of conservation philosophy and may be criticised for 'Disneyfying' the past (Handler & Saxton 1988; Waitt 2000; Choay 2001) or damaging the real purpose and the true meaning of heritage (Hewison 1987; Wright 1985), it is important to understand that how we define authenticity is a contentious issue, just like how we define the very essence of heritage itself. Indeed, the perceived authenticity of the museum and the theme parks appears of little importance to the visitors and demonstrators. Beamish continues to vehemently stress the Museum's authenticity, of which they appear particularly proud. Hangzhou and Kaifeng, on the other hand, have taken

their role as a heritage transmitter for granted and never felt the need to make claims on authenticity. This absence of gestures to claim rightful inheritance of heritage has been quite prevalent not only in historical theme parks, but also at heritage sites managed by local authorities.

For living heritage projects, such as that exemplified by Beamish, heritage is conceptualised around and centred on the people and their connections with both material evidence of the past (whether authentic, relocated or fabricated) and immaterial inheritance from the past (such as traditional knowledge, customs and practice that can be transmitted, performed or consumed). This arguable Disneyfication of Britain's industrial history was a preventive measure to save traces of the recent past before it disappeared. It stages a perceived authenticity and serves social, cultural and educational purposes through entertainment, interaction and experience.

Similar to Beamish, the Hangzhou and Kaifeng theme parks have also conceptualised heritage around the people – not merely those who have lived or are living within the city or region, but encompassing a much wider scope and referring to the descendants of Greater China. The connection of this large group of stakeholders (mostly tourists) with China's distant past has relied heavily on a fantasised fabrication of material evidence and immaterial performance. In China, the construction of historical theme parks like those in Hangzhou and Kaifeng has invariably been a joint venture between local political leadership and economic enterprise. Such Disneyfication of China's imperial history has ridden on the burgeoning demand of the new middle class for leisure, and serves cultural political purposes alongside economic, entertainment and educational ones.

Conclusion

The modification to the heritage discourse has widened the definition of heritage to include more intangible or immaterial aspects as well as encouraging consideration of the various values ascribed by stakeholders from all ranks of society. Changing conservation approaches from material-based to values-based in the second half of the 20th century and, more recently, to people-centred living heritage, have expanded significantly the scope of spatial practice of architecture and planning; they have also reformulated, or at least raised new questions about, the principles of selection, interpretation and management of the past. This shift from objective to subjective approaches to heritage management has forged closer links between communities and their pasts. In the

process, both tangible and intangible heritage are crucial to connect people and place, sustaining continuity from the past to the present and into the future.

The appropriation of heritage for economic and entertainment values – its commodification – often results in a superficial or false depiction of the past. In Beamish, the appropriation of heritage was set to compensate for the decline of Britain's industrial past and to document the communities that used to serve such industries and their claims on heritage. In a sense, Atkinson can be seen as a philanthropist or patron of the industrial history of the Northeast region. His fear of loss aroused a desire to write the history by saving the physical relics of industrial production and transmitting regional customs and traditions, thereby saving the identity of the region and further the country. The resulting tourism and economic benefits, while clearly important and of value, were secondary. The appropriation of heritage in Hangzhou and Kaifeng, however, has been essentially driven by entrepreneurial endeavours. While Beamish was created with the intent to retain the traces of the city or country's industrial past, the two theme parks in China were designed to evoke a sort of collective national memory of a bygone era. The staged authenticity in the Chinese theme parks depicts society in the past as socially inclusive; but, at the same time, supplemental new stories strengthen an implicit conception of the ethnically exclusive Greater China. Regardless of the authenticity of the sites, both the UK and Chinese case studies show their high value as heritage resources for a multitude of purposes: for reclaiming identities, for political, entrepreneurial, tourism, economic, entertainment and educational purposes. If heritage is for, and inextricably linked to people, we must therefore question what purpose stringent and limiting concepts of authenticity serve in preserving, remembering and transmitting heritage intergenerationally? While we recognise that without such means of 'gatekeeping', it could be argued that anything could become and be listed as heritage, the case studies nevertheless show that to *protect* such valued heritage, the constraints of the Western focus on authenticity, scientific evidence and objective fact, as well as on tangible heritage, are largely outdated and unoperationable for inclusive heritage management. While the people-centred living heritage approach must therefore be recognised for its increasing importance in how we conceptualise heritage and how we interpret the past for contemporary use, we must nevertheless be cautious about the selective nature of heritage practice and exclusiveness that it may consequently bring about.

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